

Fact Sheet

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Glossary

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Male, Wilsons Downfall, N.E. New South Wales [2017-509]



Female, Wilsons Downfall, N.E. New South Wales [25-055349]



Aedeagus, dorsal view (Stanthorpe, S.E. Queensland, 2017-343)



Aedeagus, lateral view (Stanthorpe, S.E. Queensland, 2017-343)



Distribution

Ta156

Name

Trachymela sp. Ta156

Reference specimen

2017-343, Wilsons Downfall, N.E. NSW

Adult Description

Length: ♀ 9.1-10.1 mm, ♂ 8.6-8.9 mm.

Colour: **head:** uniformly mid- to dark-brown with black-tipped mandibles; labrum slightly paler, usually with a longitudinally oriented darker region in centre; antennomeres 1-3 light to mid-brown, 4-11 much darker, sometimes black, individual antennomeres may be darker towards apical end; **pronotum:** brown, same shade as head, with one or two round black patches present on each side, the outer one, situated behind the eye in the foveal area, is often very small or even absent; **scutellum:** dark-brown, darker shade than adjacent area of pronotum; **elytra:** brown, same shade as pronotum, with raised black wart-like protuberances scattered over surface, some longitudinally extended and sometimes lining up in interrupted longitudinal series, punctures are similar or very fractionally darker than **interstices**, **humeral callus** black; **venter:**

uniformly very dark-brown with legs of same shade. **Waxy dorsal covering:** moderate to thick layer of grey to brown, with large longitudinally oriented patches of the different shades present, which, with the prominent black **verrucae** present a colourful patchwork of shades.

Shape: rather flattened, greatest height viewed laterally is at around or just in front of middle of elytral margin; **Head:** punctures moderately sized (pd~1.5-2xef), slightly unevenly but quite densely packed, a small flat unpunctured area sometimes present at rear middle. Antennae short (AL ♂=40-42%BL, ♀=32-34%BL), filiform, outer segments noticeably flattened. **Pronotum:** almost evenly curved transversely with lateral margins slightly explanate, **foveal depression** shallow with a clearly defined and almost round elevated area in middle, puncturation clearly impressed, similar to or more fine than those on head and slightly unevenly distributed in discal area, becoming much coarser from **foveal depression** to lateral margins, **interstices** usually smooth in discal area, less often rough but never so as to obscure punctures. Front margins join lateral margins in a smoothly rounded right-angle, with lateral margin curving smoothly and gradually towards rear margin. **Scutellum:** smooth and unpunctured. **Elytra:** surface evenly curved transversely over discal region, sometimes noticeably explanate at margins, lightly curved longitudinally in anterior half, then slightly more strongly curved, a distinct shallow depression extends across surface just in front of middle, punctures large and distinct and relatively evenly distributed between the prominent **verrucae**

and set deeply among the prominent raised interstices, the verrucae a scattered over elytral surface, with some almost round, sometimes with a small puncture in centre, others extending longitudinally and tending to form interrupted longitudinal series, surface discontinuous under **humeral callus**. Vertical extension of **epipleura** moderate ($H_{CE}/PW=0.32-0.34$). **Venter**; **Prosternal process** almost parallel-sided, lightly closed anteriorly, short setae sparsely distributed over prosternal process and mesosternum, a single seta on anterior and median **trochanter**; front edge of metasternum beveled, truncate. **Aedeagus**; moderately long ($LPE=31-34\%BL$), in dorsal view, almost parallel-sided over whole of central section before sides converge towards apex initially very gradually and evenly, before the curvature increases after a slight discontinuity, dorsal surface lightly sclerotized with faint dorso-median channel present, short but well defined dorsolateral channels present adjacent to **ostium**; tip broad, protruding and truncate, **ostium** short, roughly oval, posterior shaped as a triangle with apex at centre; in lateral view, almost evenly curved throughout basal and central section, thinning towards apex over 15% of length, tip deflexed, **flagellum** thick and spiraled where it exits ostium.

Larvae

unknown.

Eggs

unknown.

Similar species

Ta18 - this species occurs over a similar geographic range and appears very similar at first glance. It may be distinguished by the form of the black markings on the disc of the pronotum: those in **Ta18** are quite large and obliquely oval in shape, while those on **Ta156** are considerably smaller and round. The species also differ in the arrangement and form of the elytral verrucae, these being much more extended longitudinally in **Ta18**.

Ta22 - this species is also very similar but may be distinguished by the different form of the verrucae. In **Ta22**, these tend to be larger and are generally not much longer than wide; they also do not line up in longitudinal series.

Notes

One of the distinctive group of species that has a covering of waxy dust of contrasting colours. **Ta156** is distributed in the New England Tablelands of northern NSW and the adjacent areas of Queensland and has been recorded almost exclusively from *Eucalyptus andrewsii*.